

CHLOROXYLENOL

_____Name

_____Date

also called... **4-chloro-3,5-xlenol**, **4-chloro-3,5-dimethylphenol**, **para-chloro-meta-xlenol**, or **PCMX**. Sensitized persons *often also react* to the *closely related* **chlorocresol**, also known as **4-chloro-3-cresol**, **parachloro-m-cresol**, or **PCMC**.

What is it?

Chloroxylenol is an antibacterial compound used as an antiseptic or a preservative.

Where might it be found?

Antibacterial hand cleaner,
Body wash, cleanser, soap
Deodorant
Moisturizer
Hand cream, foot cream
Acne preparation
Make-up, foundation, concealer
Mascara, eye shadow
Shampoo
Hair conditioner, styling gel
Hair tonic, pomade
Depilatory wax
Sunscreen
Baby powder, foot powder
Athlete's foot treatment
Antifungal treatment
Ear drops
First aid spray, ointment
Pain relief solution
Liniment
Carbolated petroleum jelly
Urinary antiseptic
Electrode paste, EKG gel
Preoperative skin prep
Restroom soap
Hospital or clinic soap
Industrial hand cleaner
Disinfectant
Cutting fluid
Metalworking coolant
Aviary incubator cleanser
Veterinary pesticide
Veterinary fungicide
Embalming fluid

How to avoid it:

Avoid using any product that contains **PCMX** or **chloroxylenol**, or any of the names highlighted above. Check the label of each product you use to find its complete ingredient list. If this agent is present, one of its names should appear in the ingredients. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or websites such as <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>.

For possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of each solution and product encountered at work. ***Latex, vinyl, and polyethylene gloves will protect for only about 60 minutes before penetration by this substance.***

Tell your doctor about this allergy. Prescription *creams* that may contain the cross-reactor chlorocresol include aclometasone dipropionate, betamethasone dipropionate, betamethasone valerate, clobetasol propionate, and gentamicin.

Alternative cleansers that should be safe:

Ethyl alcohol-based (e.g. Purell Hand Sanitizer)
Triclosan soaps (e.g. Dial liquid, Lever 2000 bar, CliniShield Healthcare Personnel Handwash)
Triclocarban soaps (e.g. Dial bar)
Chlorhexidine scrub (e.g. Hibiclens, Betasept)
Povidone-iodine surgical scrubs (e.g. Betadine)